```
private SelectList GetCityOptions()
{
    var cities =  new List<SelectListItem>
    {
        new SelectListItem{ Value = "1", Text = "London"},
        new SelectListItem{ Value = "2", Text = "Paris" },
        new SelectListItem{ Value = "3", Text = "New York", Selected =
        ➥ true },
        new SelectListItem{ Value = "4", Text = "Rome" },
        new SelectListItem{ Value = "5", Text = "Dublin" }
    };
    return new SelectList(cities);
}
```

Methods like these, where you explicitly set the selected item, will only work if you do not bind a property to the tag helper via its `for` attribute. The value assigned to the bound property—even its default value—will override any other attempt to set the selected item.

6.3.2 Binding multiple values

So far you have used the select tag helper to enable the user to select one of a range of available options. In some cases, you might want to allow them to select more than one option. When you are working with HTML, you enable this by simply adding a `multiple` attribute to the select element:

```
<select name="cities" multiple>
```

When this attribute is present, the browser responds by rendering what is commonly called a list box—a box that lists all the options and may have a scroll bar if the contents exceed the height of the control (figure 6.10). The user can select multiple options by holding down the `Ctrl` key while selecting in most browsers.